

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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Last week: DJIA 52146.42 ▼ 490.59 0.93% NASDAQ 25520.24 ▼ 2.9% STOXX 600 641.53 ▲ 0.1% 10-YR. TREASURY ▲ 7/32, yield 4.542% OIL \$82.49 ▲ \$11.08 EURO \$1.1440 YEN 162.40

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The Trump administration** has moved sharply away from charging companies over the wrongdoing of employees, recently closing a string of criminal investigations with lenient resolutions or no charges at all. **A1**
- ◆ **Boeing Chief Executive** Kelly Ortberg said the company has started work on a new airplane design, but it is focused on playing catch-up to deliver products that are years behind schedule. **B1**
- ◆ **Truelink Capital** is nearing a deal to acquire Lyons Magnus that values the fruit-based-ingredients and beverage maker at around \$1 billion, including debt. **B3**
- ◆ **The SEC is expected** to move forward with a version of its proposal to make quarterly financial reports optional, despite being inundated with public comments that overwhelmingly oppose the idea. **B9**
- ◆ **Costco is opening** a handful of stand-alone gas stations not far from the store parking lots that usually house the stations, with the first already serving drivers in Southern California and a second planned for Honolulu. **B3**
- ◆ **Individual investors'** yearslong love affair with the market's biggest tech stocks is starting to cool as they increasingly direct money to lesser-known names in the hope that they will become the next superstars. **B1**
- ◆ **With the artificial-intelligence boom** straining power grids, China is betting on large-scale battery storage banks the size of shipping containers to help manage the load. **B1**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Iran has been stepping up** its missile-and-drone attacks on U.S. forces in Jordan as it seeks to inflict casualties on Americans and deter Washington from escalating its test of wills with Tehran. **A1**
- ◆ **Iran shipped 70 million** barrels of oil worth as much as \$6 billion between mid-June and mid-July when the U.S. lifted its blockade on the Strait of Hormuz, according to independent estimates. **A8**
- ◆ **Turkey is in talks to** transfer a sophisticated Russian air-defense system to the U.A.E in hopes of overcoming American objections to its purchase of advanced F-35 warplanes. **A8**
- ◆ **Usha Vance gave birth to** a boy on Sunday, the first time in more than 150 years that a sitting second lady had a child while her husband was in office. **A2**
- ◆ **The Pentagon added** dozens of bankers, consultants and specialists to the Office of Strategic Capital to vet contractors' operations, invest in production lines and more quickly expand the U.S. arsenal. **A5**
- ◆ **The influencers Andrew** and Tristan Tate were arrested in Miami after the U.K. sought their extradition on dozens of charges, including rape and sex trafficking. **A2**
- ◆ **Mothers and fathers** across the U.S. are alarmed by dwindling recess time for their children and are calling upon school administrators to restore it. **A3**
- ◆ **Rescue crews used** excavators to search for survivors from a landslide in the Chinese city of Chongqing that killed at least eight people and left 34 missing. **A6**

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Spain Tops Argentina 1-0 to Win the World Cup



DAVID RAVIUS/GETTY IMAGES

GOAL REACHED: Ferran Torres of Spain celebrated after scoring the winning goal in extra time for his country's 1-0 victory over Argentina in the World Cup final in East Rutherford, N.J. It was Spain's second-ever World Cup championship. **A13**

Justice Department Pulls Back On Pursuing Corporate Crime

Prosecutors eased off in some cases, even as executives were suspected

By DAVE MICHAELS AND SADIE GURMAN

The Trump administration has moved sharply away from charging companies over the wrongdoing of employees, recently closing a string of criminal investigations with lenient resolutions or no charges at all. In matters involving Alibaba, EagleBank and Abbott

Laboratories, the Justice Department declined to charge companies even when prosecutors thought executives or managers were involved in the wrongdoing. In those cases, the department didn't charge any individuals. Corporate investigations and prosecutions that were happening a few years ago "have pretty much been dialed way back," said Evan T. Barr, a former federal prosecutor now with the law firm Reed Smith. "So if you're in the world of financial services or a large public company, you can breathe a lot easier."

Charging companies is the strongest weapon in the Justice Department's arsenal for punishing businesses that violate the law. Convictions can send a strong message that wrongdoing carries public consequences. But businesses say they can also hobble a firm's ability to get financing or compete for federal contracts, and other critics say that tends to hurt shareholders and employees more than executives. In some cases, prosecutors have spared big companies from that risk by putting them on a form of corporate probation known as a deferred prosecution agreement. If the company avoids trouble over a period of several years, the Justice Department dismisses its charges. Companies typically admit to their violations, pay fines and undertake compliance and leadership changes to deter future wrongdoing. The Justice Department says companies aren't being let off easy. "All corporate cases that the department resolved this year were done so in a public fashion and were driven by the facts, the evidence, and the law—not a preference for any particular

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Jordan Becomes A Focus Of Iran Conflict

Tehran strikes U.S. ally with missiles, drones, leading to American deaths

By MICHAEL R. GORDON AND SHELLEY HOLLIDAY

Iran has been stepping up its missile-and-drone attacks on U.S. forces in Jordan as it seeks to inflict casualties on Americans and deter Washington from escalating its test of wills with Tehran, current and former officials said. The weekend Iranian missile strikes at Muwaffaq Salti Air Base, which killed two U.S. servicemembers and left a third presumed dead, were the first U.S. deaths from hostile fire since April, when the two sides announced a now-abandoned ceasefire. They were hardly the only attacks Iran has directed against U.S. forces in Jordan, as it seeks to punish the Arab country for its cooperation with Washington by making it a flashpoint while fueling the U.S. debate at home about the war. Iran also attacked King Faisal Air Base last week, where U.S. forces are also based. Iranian forces also struck a separate airfield in Jordan, where several U.S. Army Black Hawk helicopters were damaged, a U.S. official said. Separately, an American servicemember died in northern Iraq on Saturday during a controlled detonation of a downed Iranian attack drone, said U.S. Central Command, which oversees U.S. forces in the Middle East. A second servicemember was wounded and

- ◆ **Political test looms for Netanyahu.....** **A8**
- ◆ **Iran moved \$6 billion of oil amid war's truce.....** **A8**

Shortcuts In Private Equity Mint New Millionaires

By MIRIAM GOTTFRIED

In 2015, Bakari Akil was a homeless college dropout with a single focus: figuring out how to get rich. Sleeping in WeWorks, on the subway and in airport waiting areas, Akil watched videos, listened to podcasts and pored over personal-finance books. He needed to own a business, he decided. But how to do it with no money? Then Akil read a Harvard Business School case study that described how M.B.A. graduates were running around the country trying to buy companies with money from something called a search fund. He felt like he had discovered a secret. In the decade since, Akil, now 37, has bought two multimillion-dollar companies. He has spent each month of the past three years living in a different country. He is now worth seven figures. Akil is part of a growing wave of people looking for a shortcut to private-equity riches. They are ditching the well-worn path from associate to managing director and finding ways to buy HVAC and plumbing outfits, specialized manufacturers and other small and midsize businesses. Financing such deals is a far cry from traditional private equity, where firms use funds they raise from institu-

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Russian Missiles Ravage Kyiv



THOMAS PETER/REUTERS

AFTERMATH: Russia hit the Ukrainian capital with a big attack, as President Volodymyr Zelensky sought to defuse discontent over his dismissal of the defense minister. **A6**

English Old Boys' Sport Shaken Up by American Woman

Camille VanderMeer helps open-division crew row to victory in storied boat race

By JOE WALLACE

CAMBRIDGE, England—Every summer, students here line up in dozens of boats, wait for a cannon to fire, then pelt around the narrow bends of the River Cam trying to smash the crew in front. After four days of pileups, tears and the occasional ejection, the Cambridge college at the front has the glory of being named "head of the river." The competition—known as the May Bumps, despite occurring in June—is a wet and wild demolition derby in the shadows of England's most

storied halls of learning. And until this year, it was one of the oldest of old boys' sports. Then came Camille VanderMeer. The elite American rower arrived at 742-year-old Peterhouse college last fall having won the women's coxless four at the 2025 World Championships. VanderMeer had applied to Cambridge to study for her M.B.A. and hoped to row with the women's varsity team against Oxford in a contest simply known as the Boat Race, which takes place in London each spring. Please turn to page A11

CIA Man Helped Sheikh's AI Bid

Jonny Gannon aided U.A.E. in quashing U.S. concerns about Chinese ties

Jonny Gannon had one final mission. The longtime CIA operative had exfiltrated the families of spies from the most repressive of Middle Eastern regimes and tattooed the word "ARGONAUT," an homage to seafaring heroes from Greek mythology, across his

right forearm. By 2023 he had a Washington desk job with a rank equivalent to an Army two-star general. That's when the director tapped him to return to the field. His assignment: Find out whether the "spy sheikh" could be trusted with some of America's most cutting-edge technology. Sheikh Tahnoun bin Zayed Al Nahyan, the national security

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Meetings, Chats, Dates: All Are Being Recorded

By KATHERINE BINDLEY

To record or not to record? That is no longer a question for people in tech. The answer is a resounding yes. A Zoom call isn't complete without an artificial-intelligence note taker. Phones are out at meetings, capturing every word. During impromptu conversations with co-workers, someone might turn on the Granola transcription app, which can turn the interactions into one-page summaries or a list of action items. Even at bars and on dates, people are using AI-infused listening apps to analyze conversations later on. Gone are the days of any interaction being private by default. Asking for permission

is out, even though in some situations, that could mean violating the law. It isn't creepy if it's in the name of productivity, the people doing the recording say. "It happens on a daily basis," said Eric Bahn, a venture capitalist in San Francisco who started noticing it about a year ago. During his meetings with founders, they put phones out on the conference table and then inch them toward him, like he is an athlete at a postgame interview. Bahn used to ask if he was being recorded. The answer was always "Yes," followed by, "Is that OK?" Nowadays, he just assumes they are, and chooses his words more carefully. "I just see this as normal

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